

briefing, you can simply ask Alexa to check the camera feed from any particular camera, even in Picture-in-Picture (PiP) mode, without interrupting your ongoing TV feed.

On the downside, ads within the Fire TV interface can be off-putting. The inclusion of advertisements in the central strip and prominent slots within the top carousel feels intrusive.

SDR PICTURE QUALITY

4K UHD resolutions make it sharper than a comparable 43-inch Full HD TV, but at times we noticed that the TV didn't feel as sharp as other bigger 4K TVs that we had in the room even when running UHD resolution. Having said that, our experience with this TV convinces us that 4K on a 43-inch screen is a worthy advantage.

The SDR performance of the Redmi Smart Fire TV 4K 43-inch is impressive. Right away, we observed that the skin tones appeared natural and lacked the pronounced red bias often found in affordable TVs, including those from Xiaomi.

Movie mode is the most accurate colour preset with a colour temperature relatively closer to industry standard D65 and it also disables motion smoothing (at the expense of slight judder in slow panning shots). If you prefer cooler tones, you can switch to the standard mode which is less accurate and with some motion smoothing that can't be disabled.

We recorded a maximum contrast of 4462:1 in standard mode and 4083:1 in movie mode. The colour accuracy in SDR is excellent in movie mode with an average delta error of 2.5, below the humanly perceptible value of 3. Maximum errors were recorded in shades of blue.

The greyscale has some room for improvement, though. The TV undertracks the standard Gamma of 2.4 which means you will lose some details, particularly in light grey shades.

The Fire TV managed to reproduce legacy SDR content really well. The upscaling is also pretty decent. In our



tests, the panel supported 99.6% of Rec 709 colour space used in SDR content.

HDR PERFORMANCE

The TV supports basic HDR 10 and HLG. However HDR content pushes this basic panel to its limits.

We measured a maximum brightness of 226 nits which isn't enough for impactful HDR that evokes emotional response. Most of the bright highlight details were clipped in our test patterns. This might not, however, be as prominent to average consumers while watching HDR content.

We measured 87.5% DCI-P3 coverage and a BT colour volume of 69.86% in UV terms, which are above average. The colour accuracy in HDR is not as great as in SDR content but is still decent. The TV slightly undertracks the standard EOTF curve. We recorded an average delta error of 6. Skin tones have a very slight red tint in HDR content.

So to sum it up, the overall HDR performance of the Xiaomi Redmi Fire TV 43-inch is decent.

GAMING AND AUDIO

The 24W audio system performed above average and is suitable for a medium-sized room. Dialogues in movies and TV shows were clean and audible. The TV also supports Dolby Audio, DTS Virtual:X, and DTS-HD. For more impactful Audio, you will need to invest in an external audio system. This is not a TV meant for gamers and we did notice slight input lag

while gaming. This shouldn't however be a bother for basic gamers.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The Xiaomi Smart Fire TV 4K offers great value for the asking price of Rs. 24,990. The TV offers a 4K display, excellent colour accuracy in SDR and decent HDR performance in its class. The Fire OS on the TV is an intuitive interface that also has a smart home advantage in India.

So, overall, the Xiaomi Redmi Smart Fire TV 4K 43 has all that you'd expect from an affordable 43-inch TV. If you are looking for a basic option that offers a decent smart TV experience, this one is worth considering. Of course, Alexa integration and smart features are bonus advantages.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Redmi Smart Fire TV 4K 43 review:
Specifications | Panel Size: 43-inch | Panel Type: LED LCD (mix of VA and IPS panel types) | Panel Resolution: 3840 x 2160 – 4K UHD | Panel Refresh Rate: 60Hz | Supported HDR Formats: HDR10, HLG | Speakers: 24W | Audio formats: Supports Dolby Audio, DTS Virtual:X, DTS-HD | Software: Fire OS 7 | HDMI Ports: 3x HDMI 2.1 | HDMI 2.1 features: eARC | Other connectivity options: 2 USB ports, Wi-Fi 5, Bluetooth 5, Ethernet, RF connection input, Headphone out, optical input | Processor: Quad Core Cortex A55, Mali G52 MC1 (MediaTek) | Built-in RAM and storage: 2GB + 8GB | MRP - 42,999; Best Price: Rs. 24,999

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